

Information Security and Data Handling Policy

Policy ID	SEC-DATA-201	Owner	Information Security
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	All workforce members and approved third parties	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes data classification, approved storage and sharing, encryption, incident reporting, retention, and disposal requirements. Business owners remain accountable for determining appropriate access and retention.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Classification	Examples	Sharing rule	Minimum protection
Public	Published marketing	No restriction after approval	Integrity controls
Internal	Procedures and directories	Workforce and approved partners	Company account
Confidential	Customer and financial data	Named business need	Encryption and access control
Restricted	Credentials and regulated identifiers	Explicit owner approval	Strong encryption and logging

3. Storage and Sharing

Company information must be stored in approved systems appropriate to its classification. Confidential and Restricted data must not be placed in personal email, consumer file-sharing services, or unapproved generative AI tools. External sharing requires a business need, approved recipient, appropriate agreement, and the least amount of data necessary.

4. Devices, Encryption, and Remote Work

Confidential and Restricted data must use approved encryption in transit and at rest. Employees should lock unattended devices and prevent others from viewing sensitive information. Printing outside company facilities should be avoided and requires secure storage and disposal. Remote work does not change classification or retention requirements.

5. Security Incident Reporting

Suspected phishing, malware, lost devices, misdirected email, unauthorized disclosure, and unusual account activity must be reported to the IT service desk or Security immediately. Employees should preserve relevant messages and avoid independent investigation. Reporting a good-faith mistake promptly is expected and helps limit impact.

6. Retention and Disposal

Information must be retained for the period in the applicable retention schedule and legal hold. Convenience copies should be deleted when no longer needed. Paper containing Confidential or Restricted data must use secure destruction. Devices and storage media must be returned to IT for approved wiping or destruction.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: IT Access and Identity Management Policy; Acceptable Use and Device Policy; Workplace Conduct and Reporting Policy.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.